



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 10 ISSUE #11
Nov 2023

COMING EVENTS

NOVEMBER

2nd General Meeting
4th Central Coast Workshop
8th Committee Meeting
15th S'ern H'lands & I'warra
Gathering
18th North Coast Gathering
18th Fish and Chip Run

DECEMBER

7th Christmas Party & AGM
13th Committee Meeting

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What an incredible day was the Sydney Car Show, part of the Make-A-Wish Foundation.

From reports, the Austin-Healey Owners Club did the event proud with seven Austin-Healeys on show to the great crowds of onlookers who came along on Sunday 8th October at Macquarie Park.

However, it wasn't just Austin-Healeys on show as other cars present range from incredible stylised US tourers, British/US amalgams such as a Railton plus Lancia, MG, Jaguar, Brabham, Ferrari, Lamborghini and so on.

Organisers were overwhelmed with gratitude for the amazing support from the community. On the day a total of \$42,000 was

raised that will make a difference in the lives of our Wish children and their families. It was expected that the figure will rise to \$50,000 by the time final donations were tallied.

The organising team led by Emma Levy and her father (AHOC member) Bryan Levy have the right to feel proud of their achievement of gathering together such an eclectic group of historic, classic, interesting and in some case just unusual vehicles on the day.

Surely the Make-A-Wish Sydney Car Show has found its rightful place on the Sydney car scene.

We look forward to gathering together again next year and once again supporting the Make-A-Wish Foundation.



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FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Don Read

Unfortunately, it seems that almost every month we learn of the passing of one of our club members. I was saddened to hear that one of the club's founding member's, Don Read, passed away last Thursday (26th October) evening.

As usual at these times we recall characteristics of the person and my impression of Don was that he was one of those quiet achievers. He was, as I've indicated, a founding member, and up to a few years ago, and even after he and his wife Anne moved to Tallong in the Southern Highlands, was a regular attendee at our meetings and participated in many club events. Don always befriended and welcomed new members at the meetings. Later Don generously donated a great deal of his extensive collection of Healey memorabilia to the club.

Many years ago we used to hold a raffle at our club meetings, usually



Jim Phillips

organised by Terry Bancroft, with the profit going to a charity. As the treasurer during this period, I used to scratch my head and quietly curse, as to how, when tickets were priced in whole dollars, I would end up with a whole lot of shrapnel in the collection receptacle. Sometime later I learned that Don used to empty all the loose change in his pocket, I don't recall him ever winning a prize and suspect that he probably never took a raffle ticket.

On members' behalf I would also acknowledge the attention that Alan and Vicki Mitchell have given to Don after Anne passed away

and as Don's health deteriorated.

Rest in Peace Don Read

(Funeral arrangements can be found on pages 4-5)

Christmas Party and AGM

Putting these two events together always seems wrong to me. After announcing the return of holding the AGM as part of the November General Meeting I have been persuaded that last year's event was not all that intrusive on the Christmas Party thanks to a lot of

Cont' page 8

COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

Club Patron—Ross Bond

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Wyoming NSW 2250
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jpjimbeau@gmail.com

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02 9319 2299
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(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

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0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read (D), Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the
Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p.quinn@outlook.com

Greetings and welcome to the November 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and sadly it carries sad news.

It is indeed sad to report that the AHOC has lost one of its founding members, past president and life member Don Read.

Like many, Don was one of the first person I met when I joined the club back in 1972 and to me he has been a foundation brick of the club who has always been there, but now he has gone. While there is a brief collection of words on Don starting on page four I would like to include an appropriate epitaph in the next issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. So should you wish to send in some words, photos or memories of Don please do so for the next issue.

This issue contains reports of what have been quite successful events raging from the Sydney Car Show in support of the Make-A-Wish Foundation through

to the Castlecrag Classic Car Display. (Thanks Scott Graham) In between you can read about the chapter gatherings on the Central Coast, the Southern Highlands/Illawarra and the mid North Coast. Of course there are the minutes to read and absorb.

I am pleased to say that the Quinn Austin-Healey is now back in its home and is slowly going through final preparations to make it roadworthy. Lots of cleaning, paint touch ups, greasing, tuning and just general tweaking is proceeding. Just last weekend I jumped a hurdle with the car. (well not literally) During its respite, the gearbox and overdrive were rebuilt by dear friend Eric Rudd. It was close to seven to so years back, and Eric fitted new bearings, synchros, seals and so

on. It had been in and out of the car two or three times and really not used. Was the overdrive going to work? A question that woke me up at night.

So last Sunday morning it was around the block and after it was warmed up it was first thing first. A flick of the switch and it was straight into overdrive. Such a relief that I really wanted to call Eric, but sadly he is no longer with us. So I called John Sherman to let him know that I wanted to thank Eric. John understood!

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Please do send me some words and photos of what you have been up to. Also please give some thought about what you would like to say about your memories of Don Read.



Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club

Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm

Vale - Donald Edward Read**23-4-1938 - 26-10-2023**

By Christine Lyttle



It is with much sadness that we have lost one of our founding and life members of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW - Don (Donnie) Read last Thursday at a nursing home in Goulburn. Don was a very active member of the AHOC and in the early years of the Club held positions on the committee including that of president. Don's health had deteriorated over the last three years following the death of his loving wife Anne and could only attend a small number of events, though kept up to date with the Flat Chat Newsletter and the quarterly Australian Austin-Healey magazine. He never lost his wit, and this would often be heard in his conversations.

Condolences to Joan (Don's sister) and Keith Drake (AHOC members) and family and to Bart and Raelene (Anne's children) and families. Don, you will be missed. Rest in Peace.

Comments received as of Tuesday 31 Oct.

Wayne Watkins

Don was one of first Healey blokes I met at the old Leyland factory at Zetland around 1973. He will be sadly missed.

Stephen Edward Clark

Incredibly sad to learn of Don's passing. One of nature's gentlemen and a true devotee of the Austin-Healey marque. Don and Anne accepted me as a snotty nosed 12-year-old learning about life, cars and Healeys. They never judged, just encouraged and coached.

Don will be happy now he and Anne are together again. Rest in peace Reads, together forever..

Bronwyn Veale

Our visit to Sydney for the 1977 Donald Healey visit to Australia remains indelibly in our minds. A party at the Reads' of course with Donald Healey as special guest. From then on they brought the NSW Club closer to us with more sleepovers in both states for rallies. Don was always the comedian, but a straight shooter. We saw immediately the start of our eventual 50 year plus friendship. In their later years we kept in touch via the girls' weekly emails from Helen Pike, Jenny Read, Anne Read and yours truly. Our country is vast, but our friendships are close. Remembering Don as a loving husband to Anne, a true friend to all and a real club man. Rest in peace with Anne.

Paul McPherson

Condolences to Don's family and sincere feelings for our AHOC NSW friends at this sad time. Vic members remember Anne and Don fondly.

Kim Aubanel

Rest in Peace Don. I first met the Reads back in the '70s (I was in high school) when mum and dad were in the Sydney club and Scott I would tag along to meetings and events. Condolences to all of the family from the Aubanels.

Joe Jarick

A very sad occasion with Don's passing. Being there from the beginning Don and Anne were integral to the formation and life of AHOC NSW. Always a character with a fun take on life, this belied his knowledge of Austin-Healeys, speedway and much more. Farewell to a great friend as far back as my first days as a NSW club member in 1968.

Terry Wade

One of the NSW Club originals who will never be

Vale Don Read cont'

forgotten. A great enthusiast who liked nothing better than to talk Healeys and Motorsport. Another legend departed. RIP Don

Susan Darlington

Condolences on Don's passing, he and Anne always made me welcome when I was in the Healey club.

Alwyn Keepence

I was sorry to hear about Don Read. With Alan Jones, Don was the first interstate AH owner who I met, back in 1972 at the initial Coffs Harbour meet. Such a great bloke, he and Anne were good friends of mine.

Funeral Arrangements

Don's funeral will be held at St Patricks Chapel and Cemetery located at 63 Middle Arm Road Kenmore

Vale – Gordon Fryer

While probably a name that's not familiar to most of us, it's sad to report the death of Gordon Fryer on October 7th in Queensland at the age of 85.

Gordon joined the AHOC NSW in the early 1980s with a 100 and in somewhat of a sublime oxymoron, he was an undertaker with a dry sense of humour. Ray Roberts tells the story that Gordon used to visit after doing a pickup, come inside for a coffee while his passenger waited outside in a black car.

Initially Gordon Fryer was just a name on the membership list, as his time was taken up with business and caring for his wife who was unwell. Sadly she died and it wasn't long before Gordon became the AHOC social secretary and a year later the secretary.

Committee meetings were interesting, and I recall one when Gordon was reading some notes that he made on a long cardboard card with a piece of string attached. To emphasise a point, he passed the card around and after a few had looked at it, someone turned it over to see a person's name written on the other side. In response to the obvious question, Gordon responded that it was tied to the right big toe of a client that he was working with that morning. Strangely, no one else wanted to see the card, so it was given back to Gordon.

commencing at 11:00 am Wednesday 8 November. <https://us06web.zoom.us/j/86433803289> Meeting ID 864 3380 3289

If you wish to bring your Austin-Healey, a small group is asked to meet at RJ Sidney Craig Funeral Directors office, 298 Sloane Street Goulburn. Time to be advised, but approximately 45 minutes prior to the commencement of the service. Please contact Alan Mitchell as below.

Following at 12:30pm - 3:30pm at the Goulburn Soldier's Club 15/17 Market Street Goulburn. Located in the lower lounge facing the park to the right upon entry. There is timed parking (two hours) in front of the Soldier's Club and unrestricted parking at rear.

If you wish to know further details please contact Alan Mitchell on 0412 898 656 or mitchellaj@oze-mail.com.au

The 100 was sold and Gordon bought a Mk2 Roadster (HBT7/16726) and when he retired, moved to Queensland and joined the AHOC Q. Gordon subsequently married Diane, the sister of well-known Queensland Austin-Healey luminary Liam Collins. The Mk2 was sold and they bought a BJ8 (BJ8L/38062). It was advertised for sale in Queensland in January 2019.

Gordon was admitted into care, but his health deteriorated over time until his death.

Condolences to Di and to Gordon's children.





Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 5 October 2023

Meeting commenced at 7:35pm.

Venue - Strahfield Golf Club and Zoom

ATTENDEES

Natalie & Vince Cessario, Bruce Ewan (Z), Mal French, Colin Goldsmith, Richard Horwood, Peter Laurantus, Gordon & Louise Lynas, Denis Kasza, Bryan Levy, Alan Mitchell, Jenny & Ross Penman, Jim Phillips, Caroline & Patrick Quinn, Rod Richards, Muriel & Ray Roberts, Colin Rule, John & Judy Sherman, Neville Stirton, Greg Strange, Ronnie Strange, John Thornton (Z)

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

Lorraine & Dennis from Qld were welcomed as visitors to the meeting

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, George & Liz Goodare, Dianne Lawlor, Garry & Julie Lee, Christine Lyttle, Don Read, Geoff Smith.

MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 7 September 2023, as published in the October 2023 issue of Flat Chat, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim gave an update on the National Delegates Meeting, which had the purpose of being a conduit for receiving ideas from individual clubs that might have national relevance. It used to be held in conjunction with the National Rally but was now more formally constructed, with an elected President (Gordon Lynas) and Secretary (David Hillier), and the plan to meet three or four times a year.

Ideas could be put forward by any club, as long as it was supported by their committee. An example of an idea considered at the meeting was the recent proposal to have "Australia" as part of each Australian club's name. Decisions from the meeting weren't binding, so from that proposal, it appeared only the Queensland club was going to go ahead with it.

Jim advised that the AGM would be held once again at the Club's Christmas Party. He encouraged every-

one to think about nominating for a role or nominating another club member. As usual, if no prior nominations were received, nominations could be taken from the floor at the meeting.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Via Patrick then Julie, Jim had uploaded to the website a magazine from the Austin-Healey Club of Japan. Patrick advised that Google Translate did the job if people were keen to read it.



TREASURER'S REPORT

Jenny gave an update on all things financial.

Main Account	\$32,259.60
Debit Card	\$282.82
Term Deposit	\$70,000.00
Cash Reserve Acc	\$22,160.02
Charlie's Run Acc	\$1,844.15
Total Funds	
Exc Charlie's Run	\$124,702.44

We Received

Membership	\$350.00
Regalia	\$530.00
Interest	\$27.26

We Paid Out

Square Service Fee	\$4.95
Name Badges	\$21.00

MEMBERSHIP

Jim advised that membership cards would shortly be available from the website, so members could print their own if they wanted one.

John Thornton raised that some members at Illawarra & Southern Highlands events were keen to get their membership badges. He was to send a list to Jim so this could be followed up with Christine.

SOCIAL SECRETARIES' REPORT

Bruce ran through the social calendar for October then handed over to Colin Rule (Central Coast Chapter workshop on the 7th), Bryan Levy (Make A Wish event on the 8th), and John Thornton (Joadja Distillery Tour & Tasting on the 18th) to provide more details. John confirmed that the dirt road section of the run to the distillery had been checked a few times to make sure it was OK for ageing British sports cars!

John took the opportunity to advise that he and David McIntyre were in the process of planning all the I&SH Chapter events for 2024, so once ready, the calendar would be sent to the Committee for approval. One event they were considering was a 2-3 day trip down the Old Hume Highway, possibly in September. Members present showed interest, so John was advised to go ahead with the idea although it was noted some members might still be away after the August National Rally in WA.

Denis advised that a paddle wheel lunch cruise was also being planned.

Bruce also mentioned the October Mid-North Coast Chapter event. Overall, the chapters were attracting good numbers to events so he passed on his thanks to the various chapter organisers.

A last word from John T was on the venue for the I&SH Christmas lunch – the Plough & Ale Hotel in Bowral.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim advised that PayPal would be available shortly as well as a multi-year membership form. The Committee was also constructing an asset register to keep track of the Club's equipment and other bits and pieces. Once completed, he'd upload this to the website.

David Baggs from the Qld AHOC had very helpfully developed a manual for the website.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Jim advised that member Geoff Golding was very unwell. Jim had met him at work, so had known him for around 50 years.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick advised that Flat Chat had gone out the previous evening.

REGISTRAR



Patrick gave an update on conditional registration activity.

HISTORIAN

No Report.

LIBRARIAN

No Report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

Greg noted that he had a few cars through his workshop with aftermarket brake boosters that didn't have a one-way valve fitted. This could lead to a loss of vacuum so was something to watch out for.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

No report.

CMC REPORT

The CMC had met a week or so previously. Apparently the annual show at Eastern Creek in August was the biggest and best they'd had. Ray reminded the Club about renewing its affiliation for 2024.

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

Jim talked about the recent All British Day. Although overall car numbers had potentially been down, it had been a really successful day and the Club had been allocated a prime position!

CSCA REPORT

News from Mr Lexus, AKA Colin Goldsmith, was

that the previous week's MGCC Supersprint had only attracted 34 cars, which was a bit disappointing. The upcoming Jaguar Club Supersprint on 22 October would be the last for the year.



Colin added that it was looking like a few clubs wouldn't be running events in 2024, which wasn't good, but then again if there were fewer events, it might help with better numbers competing. HSRCA also have their historic meeting coming up at Sydney Motorsport Park in November.

REGALIA

As usual, Colin had a deal for everyone! There were hats, laminated wiring diagrams, faux placemats, books, chrome number plate holders and banners! In the slightly more stylish category, he had genuine leather sleeves for car logbooks for \$35. He also displayed a sample shroud cover which could be customised with the Club's logo, but there were no takers.

Pres Message cont'

preparatory work by secretary Julie Lee and that we should do it again.

So apologies for the wrong information last month, but at least you now have an additional month to consider who you want to manage the functioning of the AHOC for 2024. Due to some stuff ups by the webmaster, it would be good to give him the heave ho, and frankly I would like to sack him, but to do so we will need a replacement. If you're interested, or know someone who would be able fill this role please come and see me and I'm happy to talk to your kids or grandkids about how

On a completely different note, he mentioned that he'd been to see the Club's patron, Ross Bond recently. Ross was in a nursing home, but doing ok, and keeping himself busy. Colin felt strongly that Ross' story in relation to Austin-Healeys needed to be told.

SHOW & TELL

N/A

FOR SALE OR WANTED

Patrick went through a list of items which Mal French was parting with – they were leftovers from the BN6 Mal had sold.

Nevile Stirton had a new 6-cylinder alloy bonnet available.

Colin Rule had a second-hand front bumper bar for a 100.

GENERAL BUSINESS

- Alan advised that there were roadworks happening southbound on the Hume Highway.
- Gordon mentioned that Charlie's Run was set for 20-27 March, to Lightning Ridge. Details were in the October Flat Chat.
- John Thornton and Bruce Ewan 'fessed up that they'd been discussing the idea of a "dog run" while the meeting had been going on so Jim suggested they go ahead with it!

Meeting concluded at 8:35pm.

they can help you.

As mentioned previously the ability to nominate someone for a position will close prior to the AGM. Voting will only be required for those positions where there is more than one nominee. Where there are no nominees for a position, nomination will be sought at the AGM and dealt with in the usual manner.

After that it will be party time and I look forward to seeing you there on 7th December at Strathfield Golf Club.





Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
Bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008
deniskasza@gmail.com

October leading into Christmas was an opportunity for the Austin-Healey Owners Club to take a slightly different tack to the many other events delivered through 2023, plus those yet to happen. It was an opportunity to deliver joy, create experiences and give back to community.

The inaugural Sydney Car Show, part of the Make-A-Wish Foundation, was a huge success in 2022 and once again in 2023. Much of that success was driven by the wonderful support and efforts of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW.

AHOC member Brian Levy and daughter Emma put thousands of hours into creating this event, that delivered interesting cars and something to see for everyone.

Thanks to Ray Roberts for attending multiple car events and shows, handing out flyers. Rod Richards for collecting and delivering banners. Many other club members assisted in various guises from display to contacting other car owners and a whole lot more.

All of this led to a great visitor turn out in the thousands, lots of very happy kids and families, but most importantly the life changing dreams to be delivered for some children who need a little joy.

AHOC members who attended Make-A-Wish Foundation Display Day were: Bryan Levy - BN1 and BJ8, Bruce Ewan, Rod Richards - BJ7, Ray Roberts - BJ8 and MGA Twin-Cam, Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor - Sprite Mk3, Richard Horwood and Mark Sullivan Jaguar XK120 and Chrysler Valiant, Neville Stirton with son Paul – Austin-Healey 3000 BT7 and Speedway Sprintcar, Robert Hosking - BJ8, Denis Kasza Austin A99 Westminster and Caroline and Patrick Quinn.

Paul Stirton was incredibly patient in showing youngsters how to get in and out of his incredible Sprintcar - through the roll cage, removing the steering wheel, taking photos, creating memories, and a

whole lot more. Few will understand the power of this beast (over 900hp), or the speed it could manage, hence the need for the roof foils. These experiences may create the next generation of racing superstars, saving us from the future boredom of electric self-driving normality.

The Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW won the award for the best club display of the day.

With Christmas fast approaching, November is your last chance to get out and meet up for 2023 chapter events. Geography, breadth of offering, the number of people attending events, plus the support of each chapter has grown substantially over the year.

So if you are attending one of the club events please say a quick thank you to the Chapter coordinators Colin Rule, John Thornton, Phil Lorking and Denis Kasza. Please pass on any suggestions for future runs and outings.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Central Coast Chapter

Date: Saturday November 4th

Venue: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber

Time: 9:00am

Bring: Morning tea to share e.g. cake, biscuits or similar

Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

Event: Plough and Ale Hotel

Date: Wednesday 15 November

Times: Start 12:00 PM

Address: 10 Connection Rd, Calderwood Valley

Register: Please register in advance so that we can reserve tables and confirm numbers

Contact: John Thornton 0419 266 284 or john.thornton2011@outlook.com

AHOC Sydney Area

Fish and Chip Run

Date: Saturday November 18th

Venue: Water Vista Cafe, 199 Bay Rd, Berowra Waters

Time: Dinner from 6.30pm

For those wanting a convoy run, meet at McGraths Hill Maccas, 242 Windsor Rd, Vineyard at 5pm, departure for Berowra Waters at 5.30pm, approximately 40 minute drive.

Soc Report cont'

Mid-North Coast Chapter

Saturday 18th November

Date: Saturday 18 November

Times: Start 9:00 am

Address: 79 Barton St, Croki

Bring: Morning tea to share e.g. cake, biscuits or similar.

AHOC NSW Christmas Party

Date: Thursday 7 December

Venue: Strathfield Golf Club

Address: 52 Weerona Rd, Strathfield

Times: Start 6:30 PM

Register: PLEASE register in advance so that we can cater accordingly

Pricing and details to come shortly.

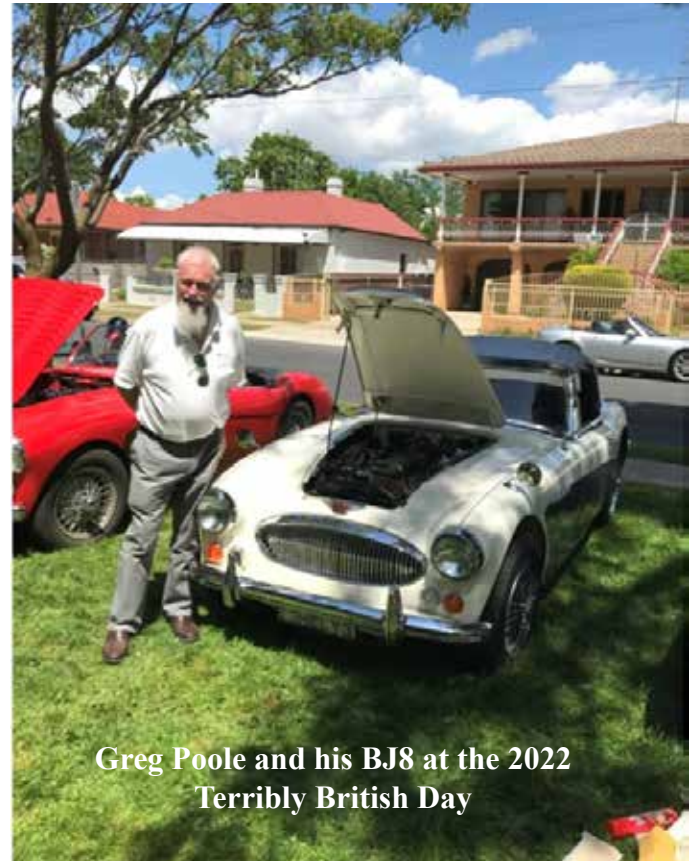
Terribly British Day – Queanbeyan, 3 December 2023

Bathurst member Greg Poole is heading to the annual 'Terribly British Day' in Queanbeyan held on the first Sunday in Dec. Greg wonders if anyone would like to join him in this popular event.

Greg says that they usually head to Canberra on the Saturday before, staying overnight at Rydges Capital Hill, attend the event followed by dinner at Manuka on Sunday evening and head home on Monday morning.

While all roads don't necessarily lead from Bathurst to Canberra, I am sure that a meeting place along the way could be organised.

If interested, give Greg a call on (02) 5355 0079.



**Greg Poole and his BJ8 at the 2022
Terribly British Day**

Membership Report -

Christine Lyttle

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

We have no new members this month.

It was sad to hear of the passing of member Greg Tucker after a long illness on 31 August 2023. I have only been aware of this sad news in the past couple of weeks. Greg has been a member since 2004 and was very well known in the Bathurst area, being a member of many associations and having been the manager at Panorama Travel for many years. Our condolences go to his wife, Sandy and their family.

On Thursday 26 October 2023 Don Read passed away at a nursing home in Goulburn. Don has been mourning the loss of his dear wife Anne for three

years and he now joins her in their heavenly home. Don was one of the founding members of our Club which commenced on 9 March 1969. Both Don and Anne were very active members of the club and Don served on the committee as president for quite a few years. Our condolences to his sister and brother-in-law, Joan and Keith Drake (both members) and their families. The past few years Alan Mitchell has also been looking after Don and his affairs.

Don't forget if you change your email address, street address or your car details, please update them online as you have access through your membership. Should you have any issues accessing, then contact either Jim Phillips our webmaster or myself.

Please let me know if you have any questions and will get back to you with a reply.



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Log Books! If you have a vehicle Conditionally Registered through the AHOC you would have been issued with a log book when you renewed the registration.

What the log book does is to allow you to use your vehicle for up to 60 times in a calendar year for maintenance and personal use, in addition to AHOC events. Each day of use must be recorded in the log book. Multiple uses during a day are part of a single use.

The log book has spaces for writing in the date, the full name of the driver and a signature. Generally it will be you the owner, filling in the spaces, but if you lend your car, it can be whoever you lent it to. In other words it

doesn't have to be the owner of the car who fills in the log book.

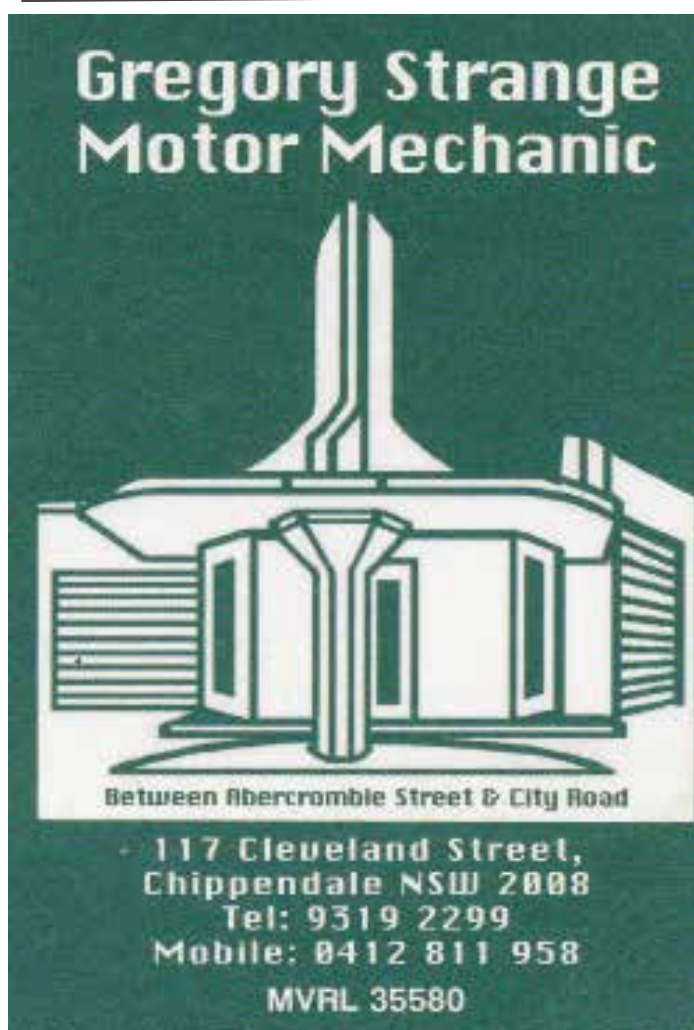
Log books need to be carried in the car when it is in use, as is the mauve coloured Certificate of Approved Operations that you received when the registration was renewed and the registration certificate.

If you go on a multi day journey you need to fill in the log book every day, except of course if you happen to be on a club event when completion of the log book is not required. On these occasions make sure you are carrying a copy of the page from Flat Chat detailing the run.

We have a number of conditionally registered trailers within the AHOC and when these are towed behind a conditionally registered vehicle, log books for both must be completed and carried.

So you don't have to ask, the registration renewal steps are below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Chapter News

Central Coast Chapter Workshop - 7 October



Colin Rule, Doug Ross, Richard Cardew, Geoff Rudland, Jenni Richter, Jim Phillips, Roger Ramsey, Garry Lee (Julie is behind the camera), Scott Parry-Jones, Ian Richter, Tony Ash, Richard Horwood, Heath Terry, John Kirk and Larry Johns.

Another stunning spring Saturday morning for our Central Coast workshop held on 7 October.

A very big thank you to Jenni and Ian Richter for hosting the workshop.

An absolute gorgeous setting nestled in the foothills of the Ourimbah hinterland where 16 intrepid Austin-Healey enthusiasts gathered once again to experience the barebones restoration of Ian and Jenni's BN1.

The topic for the day was, 'Sometimes better to repair, than to cut out and replace chassis componentry'. On this occasion we addressed the bottom of the chassis rails and the damaged engine mounts. The morning's effort put this part of the restoration to bed.

Another big 'well done' to Tony Ash from Diamond Beach near Taree for once again driving all the way to attend the morning. Well done Tony!

There were two newbies for the morning. They were club member Geoff Rudland and first time to an

event driving a very nice BJ8, and Heath Terry.

The other true believers were Larry Johns BN2, John Kirk 3000 MK1, Richard Horwood, Tony Ash 3000 BT7 MK11, Doug Ross, Scott Parry-Jones BN4, Julie and Garry Lee BJ8, Jim Phillips BN4, Jenni and Ian Richter BJ7, Richard Cardew Sunbeam Alpine, Roger Ramsey and yours truly BN1.

The workshop concluded with our customary coffee, cookies and cake plus two delicious cheesecakes, all finishing up around 12 noon. Another very successful Central Coast Austin-Healey workshop.

The next workshop will be held at Geoff Smith's, 20 Long Arm Parade, St Huberts Island on November 4th starting at 9am. Don't forget to bring a plate to share. The topic for the morning is, 'Fitting side screens to a 3000 MK11 3000 with hardtop'.

Take care and Happy Healeyng. Col and Kerrie Rule.

Con't next page

Central Coast cont'

**Mid North Coast Chapter – October 21st**

Due to a number of members being unavailable for the technical morning on October 21st it was decided to take the cars for a run to the Moorland Tea Rooms, "Best Scones On The Coast", at Moorland, 33k north of Taree.

Present on the run were Tony Ash and Liz Lutherborrow, Phil and Anthea Lorking, Chris and Jordon (son) Hatch, Doctor Sesh (new member of the Austin-Healey community) who bought the red 100/6 from Melbourne a few months ago.

The scones and coffee went down well along with of course "Healey Chatter".

Next Meeting is on Saturday 18th November at Croki.

Cheers Phil Lorking – 0412 392 362



Chapter News cont'

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters Joadja Historic Town

Wednesday 18th October 2023

David McIntyre put together a fantastic, fun filled day for Illawarra and Southern Highlands AHOC members on Wednesday, 18th October 2023.

Joadja was established in 1870s by Scottish immigrants who discovered shale, then used in the production of kerosene. The town reached a population of around 1,000 people and the mining finished in the early 1900s.

Our group enjoyed ourselves, so much so, that I will be adding another visit to Joadja to next year's events and include a tour of the whole "Historic Village of Joadja". That's right, we only did the "Tasting Tour". The owners, Valero and Elisa Jimenez gave us the history of the Joadja Valley. Their decision to purchase the property in 2011 is a truly fascinating story.

One of Valero's many interesting stories is when he was approached in 2019 by a representative on behalf of the NSW Governor, Margaret Beazley to produce a "special edition" gin to be used as an "Official Gift from the State of NSW".

When the Governor was invited to meet the Queen, in London, as part of the Queen Elizabeth II Platinum Jubilee, the Governor gifted a bottle of the Joadja "Special Edition Gin" to Her Majesty as a gift from the people of NSW.

The group eagerly participated in the tasting of the full range of the Joadja Distillery gins and whiskies. Truly an experience!



David McIntyre was pleased to see that his Austin-Healey Sprite MkIII was not the only Austin in the paddock. As Chris Fitzpatrick noted, "There is a 100 engine in there looking to get out!"



After our tasting the group headed off to the historic town of Berrima, to be joined by Greg and Kathy Barnsley in their 100/6 BN6. We adjourned to the dining room of the Surveyor General Hotel for a great lunch, with a lot of talk and chatter throughout the afternoon and finally left for home around 4:00pm.



(L to R) John & Fran Thornton, Annie & Rob Sassall, Lyn & Chris Fitzpatrick, Michelle & David McIntyre.



Straight 8 Railton



Delightful Lancia



Yes there were Ferraris and Lamborghinis.



Brabham



Certainly not my cuppa, but you had to admire the paintwork



Sydney Car Show Team

Sent in by Joe Armour and just as relevant today as it was when Geoff Healey wrote it in 1991.

Healey

Healey Automobile Consultants Ltd.
Four High Street,
Barford,
Warwick CV35 8BV,
Tel 0926 624 383

To the Editor,

ENGINE COOLING

25 October 1991

Ref. No. 3003

I recently visited a well known restorer of Austin Healeys who complained bitterly about the difficulty he was experiencing in trying to keep the water temperature down on a competition vehicle. A quick look under the bonnet revealed the cause of the problem was the complete lack of any baffling around the radiator. If restorers do not understand the problems involved I felt that I should explain our past findings on the subject.

In the late fifties we were investigating what appeared to be cooling problem in high ambient temperatures. We took over the paint shop and raised its temperature and put the car in it. We then measured the time it took for the engine to boil when idling. The time was very short. Testing a larger capacity radiator or larger fan produced little improvement. We then checked air circulation at many points around the radiator with an anemometer and found that the fan was drawing air through the radiator and that much of this heated air then moved round the sides of the radiator and was drawn through again. The use of smoke (a pipe will generate enough smoke) will make the circulation of air readily apparent. It was apparent that very little fresh air was being drawn through the grille at the front. We then experimented with baffles fitted to ensure that the air that had passed through the radiator could not get round to the front of it again. It was also found that air passing through the radiator could also return over the top and under the bottom of the radiator.

Suitable baffles at the side of Austin Healey radiators are often left off or bent away to ease radiator fitting and this causes a hot running engine.

MG workers often bent the baffles to speed production but Syd Enever managed to ensure that cars left the factory with correctly fitted baffles. Garages always bent baffles to ease radiator fitting. Fitting a larger fan without correcting the baffle fitting will only worsen engine heating. The cooling fan action causes the air pressure to rise in the engine bay and to decrease (pressure) in front of the radiator. Air then flows from the high to the low pressure region.

Before going to the expense of fitting larger fans or radiators or spending money with a specialist, ensure that your car has efficient baffling.

We rarely used fans on competition vehicles but relied on efficient ducting and baffling to make sure that the vehicle's forward motion generated sufficient air flow through the radiator. The very efficient ducting ensured that the last racing Sprites we built used very small radiators and raced in high ambients without any cooling problems.

Geoffrey Healey



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info@platinumsash.com.au

13 Wilham Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters
PLOUGH & ALE HOTEL



Christmas Is Almost Here!

Come and join the *Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters* for our final meeting of the year at noon on Wednesday 15th November 2023 at the Plough & Ale Hotel 10 Connection Road, (Corner of Escarpment Drive) Calderwood Valley.

Easy to find, good parking and great food.

David McIntyre and I have put our heads together over the last month, focusing on events for 2024. We have more than a full calendar of events, but let us know if there is something you think will excite the group.

I will publish the 2024 events list in the December 2023 edition of the Flat Chat Newsletter, so you can plan well ahead. Our first Chapter event will be in February 2024.

Send me a reply and let me know you are coming to the Plough & Ale Christmas Lunch so I can confirm the numbers.

Email: john.thornton2011@outlook.com

Mobile: 0419 266 284

The November meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 2nd at Strathfield Golf Club. You can also attend by Zoom. ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

Castlecrag Classic Car Display

By Scott Graham

I've always enjoyed watching the unique and classic cars of Castlecrag drive by the cafes on a weekend and thought it would be fun to get them together for a display.

Last Sunday October 22nd, along with the Castlecrag Fair, we gave it a shot and put on a lovely display of local classic cars that was the highlight of the fair.

For space reasons, the show was limited to 30 cars, which gave us an opportunity to be picky. The theme was "Local Classics", defined as postcode 2068 and built from 1925 to the 1974 oil crisis.

In preparation, I spent lots of time twisting arms and door knocking strangers and making loose promises. "Bollards? Of course."

We picked the prettiest, raunchiest, and classiest cars. There were a few painful misses – a '57 Eldorado Brougham with a stainless-steel roof for one, but got most of what we targeted.

In the end, we'd somehow covered the waterfront – from iconic Italian to functional French, British bulldogs and anabolic Americans.

And we managed to avoid making it a Porsche show. Seems everyone has a porker they want to show off. However my made-up rules kept them in check, with only two there on the day.



The lineup of cars was wonderfully eclectic and included: Citroen 2CV ute, 75 Cadillac Eldorado, Ferrari Dino 246, 1927 Austin Seven, Caterham



Scott Graham with his BJ7 in the background

Castlecrag cont'

Seven, '73 Porsche 911T, TVR Griffith, Jaguar E-type Mk 1 ½, Chev Camaro drag car (650hp), '74 Porsche 11 Carrera, Jensen Interceptor Conv, 1929 Bentley Speed Six Le Mans Rep, Pagoda Mercedes SL, Plymouth Satellite, Corvette Stingray, Austin-Healeys BJ7, BJ8 and Bugeye, 2CV Charleston, Renault Gordini, Citroen DS21, MGB bash car, Triumph Stag, 1947 MG TC SC, Lotus Elite 75.



Everyone really got into the best of show vote, we got over a hundred votes. Sadly, positioning my BJ7 and Bugeye near the voting forms didn't result in a go for me. Maybe next time!

Anyhow, the winners were:

Best of show:	Dino 246
Runner up:	Bentley Speed Six
Second runner up:	Corvette Stingray

The guys were a lot of fun, great stories about the little Austin Seven driving to Perth, the adventures of the big Speed Six and how to detune a drag racer to "only" 650HP.

The feedback was great, and I expect we'll be invited back next time.

* Some of these were called in – emergency call at 10pm the night before to help my mate fit mudflaps on his 2CV and at the end of day drove a number of cars home to their rented garages around the north shore.



FOR SALE-NOT QUITE

FOR SALE - NOT QUITE

Good Evening Healey owners While not a member of the Austin Healey Owners Club I have owned a BN2 since 1970. Joe Armour knows the car and myself. I am writing to the club as I am about to down size to a smaller residence. Early on in my ownership I purchased a BN1 in bits and still have two doors, and a boot lid all in fair condition, what I think is a A90 cast iron head plus some other odds & sods. Rather than taking them to the local tip I was wondering if they would be of any use to members of the club. I am not wanting to sell them rather passing them on to an owner who might want them. I live in Mt Keira and can be contacted on the number below.
Regards Dennis Norton

Dennis Norton
0419 099 729
northwall@bigpond.com

Interesting Photo and Interesting Cars

I receive all sorts of messages about the things I'm interested in – mostly planes, trains and automobiles.

One such source is Pre-WarCar.com & PostWarClassic.com which goes some way in satisfying my liking for both pre-WW2 cars and those made in the couple of decades or so after. Most entries are of interest, but this photo really caught my attention. PQ.



We don't see sights quite like this anymore. What an exciting showroom, stuffed full of exotic sports-cars, some of which, being second-hand, might have been quite attractively priced. The most ordinary car we can see is the Austin Cambridge in the far left of the window. Next to it, the MGA and MG TF both offer something a little racier for the sports-car enthusiast, but it's what's on the other side of the building that really gets our attention.

The Austin-Healey 100, named for its 100mph top speed, would have been hot stuff when the picture was taken in the late 1950s. One of the salesmen has painted 'Disc Brakes' across the windscreen which was, of course, quite the selling point. (that caught my attention. Yes it's a 100, but with disc brakes! Perhaps the salesperson was trying a fast one. PQ)) Similarly impressive is the Jaguar 2.4 or 3.4 Litre parked by the roadside. That, too was a disc-braked car with a 100mph top speed, or 120 mph if it was the 3.4. A figure like that was pretty earth-shattering for a saloon car which could seat five in the utmost luxury and comfort. By far the most interesting cars, though, are the two which have been wheeled out onto the pavement for all the world to admire.

On the left is a Lotus Mk. VI, of which just 110 were made between 1952 and 1957, just before Colin Chapman discovered more widespread commercial success with the Lotus Seven. The other car is an HRG 1500, another rarity - only 242 HRGs of all models were ever built - with some interest-

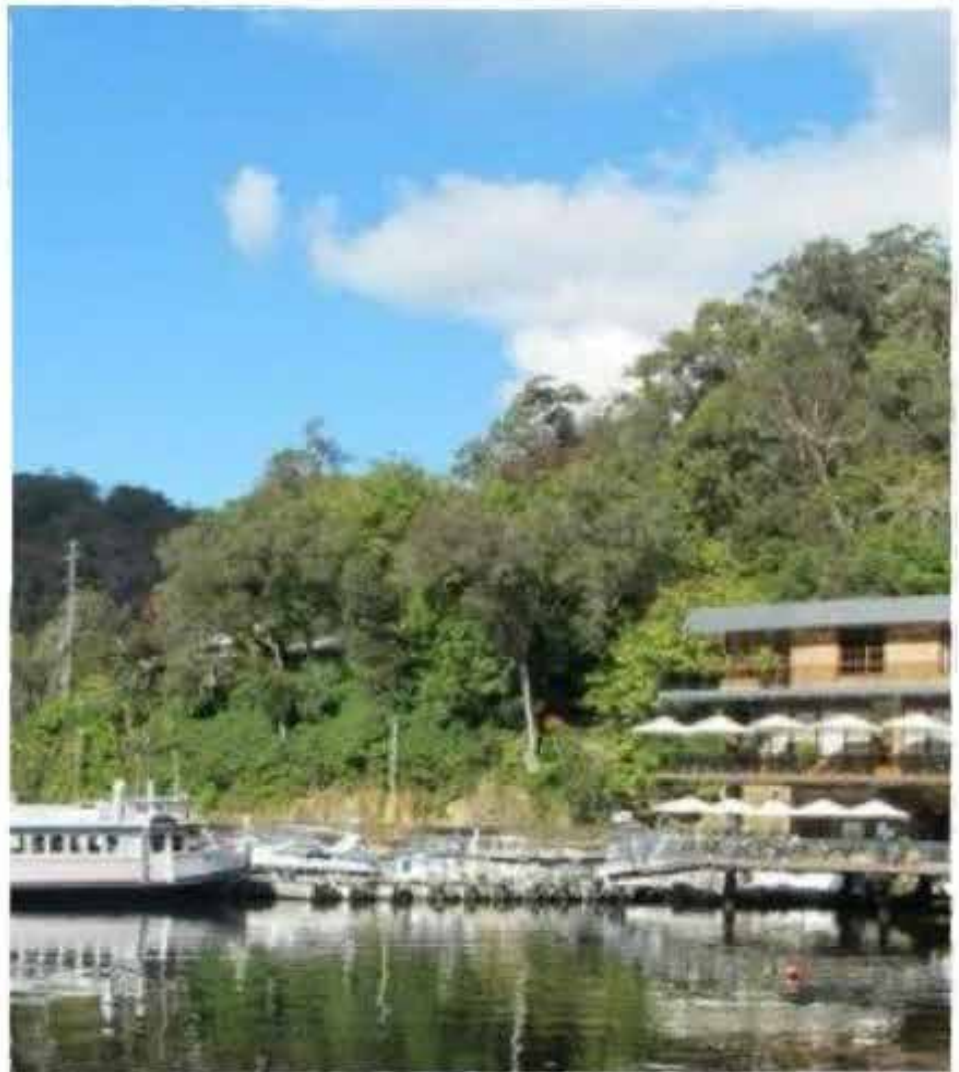
ing provenance. In the early and mid-1950s, it had been actively campaigned in Motorsport by Mrs. D. Osmond in such events as the Exeter Trial and the Birmingham Post Rally. Also visible in the shadows, just behind the Lotus, is an Aston Martin DB2/4.

As well as the cars themselves, there's a price list in the window which also makes for interesting viewing:

1934 Aston Martin £1350
 1958 MGA £815 | '58 MGA £775
 1958 Tojeiro Climax £975
 1956 Austin-Healey £725
 1952 TD MG £445
 1954 MG TF £365 | TF £575
 1948 MG £275
 1951 Jowett Jupiter £375

We might well wonder what's become of it all. Eagle Motors was located at 1124 London Road in Norbury (actually in Surrey, but only a stone's throw from the London boundary), at the corner with Kilmartin Avenue, where there was a clear view down to the newly-constructed Crystal Palace transmitting tower. The building still stands, but these days it's a pretty depressing sight as it has obviously been vacant for some years and is slowly falling into disrepair. Happier news, though, is that at least three of the cars still survive. The 1954 MG TF and 1958 MGA continue to be taxed for English roads, while the HRG has found a very enthusiastic owner all the way across the world in New Zealand.

NOV
18



SAT NIGHT FISH'N CHIPS

**Water Vista Cafe 199 Bay
Rd Berowra Waters,
Sat 18 November
Meet McGraths Hill Maccas
5pm dep 5.30, 40 minutes
drive. Denis 0407492008
Bruce 0432096493**



The Opal Fossicker

Charlie's Run - 20-27 March 2024



Thank you to everyone who has already booked for the "Opal Fossicker". My provisional motel bookings are filling fast, so if you want to join us don't delay, book your place today!



2024's Charlie's Run is going to Lightning Ridge. Not only are there black and other opals to be found, but the town also has thermal springs that feed two artesian bore hot water pools, so bring your bathers for a dip.

There are of course lots of opal themed things to do, see and buy as well as the John Murray Art Gallery and several opal mining museums including one built out of bottles, and that's all just within the township.

As usual we will take a reasonably relaxed tour, both to get there and to return. Our provisional schedule is as follows:

Wednesday, 20 March – Travel to Orange.

Thursday, 21 March – Orange to Gilgandra with a detour via the Orange wine region.

Friday, 22 March – Arrive at Lightning Ridge for a three-night stay to enjoy fossicking, exploring and checking out the opals and other delights.

Monday, 25 March - Depart Lightning Ridge for Gunnedah.

Tuesday, 26 March - Overnight at Denman, hopefully with a last night dinner included.

Wednesday, 27 March - Home.

This should mean that we will driving for three to

four hours each day leaving time for a leisurely lunch and to have an afternoon stroll around each new town.

The cost of this run will be around **\$600 per person in a double or twin room, or around \$900 for a single room** for the seven nights' accommodation excluding meals.



To book your place email or call Gordon (gordonl@aussiebb.com.au or 0403 198 343) and don't forget to pay your deposit of **\$50 per person to the club by EFT, including your name and reference 'Opal'**.

If you can't add a text reference, most banks will allow you to add a numeric reference so please use your club membership number or, if you don't know that, your postcode, to help me identify your payment.

If you are not able to make an EFT, please deposit a cheque at your local Westpac bank payable to the Austin-Healey Owners Club NSW account detailed below and let Gordon know that you have done so by email or phone.

Westpac Bank: BSB 032 669, A/c no. 277411
'AHOC Charlies Run'

Happy Healeying,
Gordon Lynas





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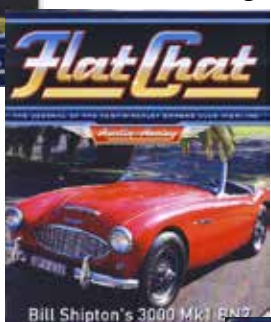
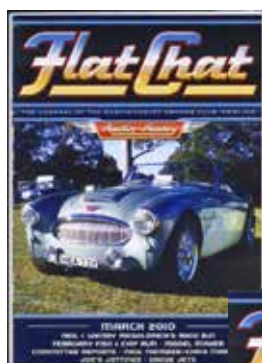
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Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



AHOC - Circa 1971

Many thanks to Ray Roberts for sending the below photos taken during a motorkhana in 1971. From the information on hand they were taken by Ian Morgan who was the Club's photographer at the time. Ian owned the black over white BJ8 that is now owned by Chris and Dina Dimmock.

Both the location and faces are not known, but I think I do recognise a gentleman by the name of Doug Treloar who would go on to become a good friend. Doug joined the AHOC in late 1971, just a few months before I did and being an accountant became the treasurer.



Tyre Shaving

For years I have wondered about the North American pursuit of tyre shaving. Why? Surely you fit new tyres, they're balanced and away you go. Clearly not, if you are in the US or Canada. So my Kiwi friend and Canadian resident Mike Salter sent the below. I have not changed the different spelling.

Some of you may remember my first foray into tire shaving using a table saw. Although this exercise was quite successful it was somewhat dangerous and very time consuming. Ever since shaving the tires on my 100 in this way I have been blessed with a very smooth ride and no signs of scuttle shake however, all good things must come to an end, and the time arrived to replace the tires on B.#174.



In an effort to preserve the car's originality I have opted to use the original "flat center" 48 spoke Dunlop wire wheels. Unfortunately, these 60-year-old wheels, although still in fairly good condition have some run-out and are not perfectly round and, after installing a new set of tires, the scuttle shake gremlins came back with a vengeance.

I had previously looked into having my wheels and tires shipped to one of the very small number of companies providing this service in the U.S. but very quickly learned that the shipping alone was prohibi-

tively expensive

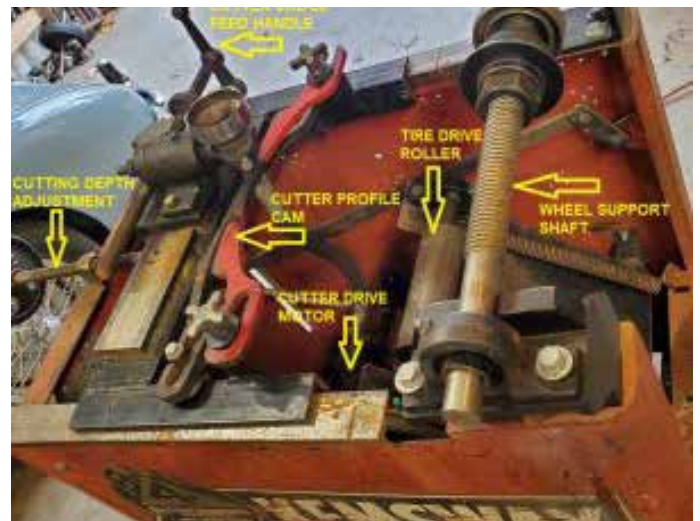
Coincidentally around the same time a very good friend was disposing of a Kensway Tire Conditioner for which he had no further use.

Although this machine was somewhat beat up and looked a bit sad after being modified to be used for shaving 10" mini race tires a couple of days of fettling returned it to some semblance of its original glory.



This is quite a device and nothing like it is available today, because modern automotive wheels and tires are made so accurately that shaving is really no longer required.

I spent quite a bit of time turning up a pair of adaptors specifically for Dunlop wire wheels and creating a new tread profile cam to suit tires for regular road use.



Tyre Shaving cont'

The result was nothing short of miraculous as both tread shaving and static balancing can be performed very accurately with this machine.

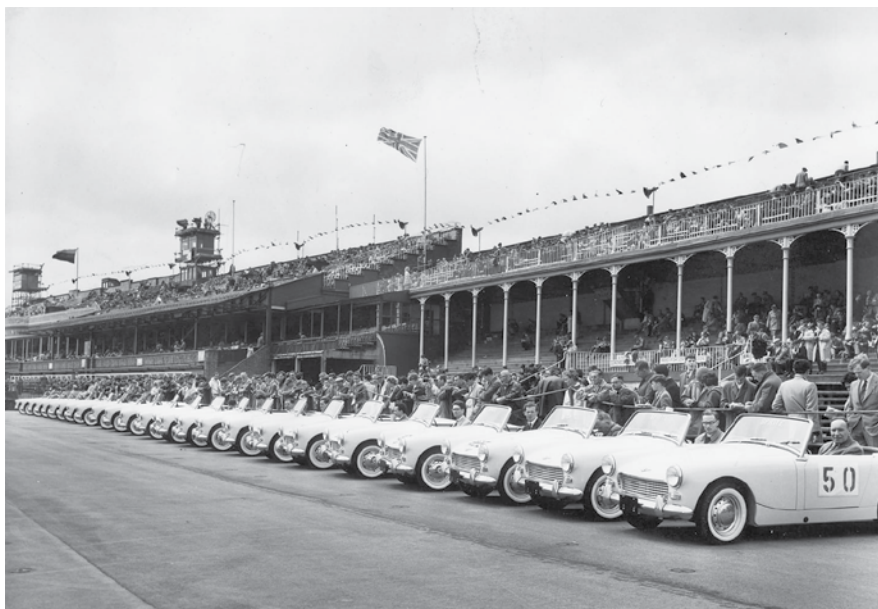
I did learn quite quickly that when shaving tires which have been used on the road that it is absolutely essential to ensure that all stones, regardless of size, need to be dug out of the treads before starting as contact with just one is sufficient to dull the cutter blade requiring that it be resharpened.

The biggest win resulting from this exercise is that something that took all day with the table saw method can be achieved in a couple of hours and, with the balancing produces even better results.



Thank you to Damien Carrick for these two photos.

Both were taken at the British Grand Prix at Aintree.



The top photo was taken in 1955 while the bottom was in 1961.

FOR SALE**Honest Terry's Used Car Emporium (closing down sale)****1961 Austin-Healey 3000 BT7 Mk2 \$105,000**

An older restoration from the early 1990s still looks stunning today, white over black colour scheme, black interior with white piping. Factory hard top, soft top included, but it has a few minor problems. Car starts, runs and drives very nicely. Imported from the USA as LHD and has been converted to RHD. A few minor blemishes on the paint (on the bonnet), more pictures can be seen on the carsales advert at <https://www.carsales.com.au/cars/details/austin-healey-3000-1961/sse-ad-16047265/>

**1984 Mercury Capri ASC/McLaren 5.0 SC Convertible \$39,500**

What I hear you ask is that? Mercury Capri (based on the Mustang chassis), Ford/Mercury gave the cars to ASC (American Sunroof Company, also known as American Specialty Cars) and they created the convertible, added the styling and on the coupe versions of this, stiffened the suspension. The Capri is LHD. This is number 11 of only 50 convertibles built this year. The car starts easily and drives, well, like a mid-eighties Mustang. More pictures and information can be accessed at <https://www.carsales.com.au/cars/details/mercury-capri-1984/sse-ad-15980340/>

**1990 TVR S3C 290S \$25,000**

The car is finished in silver over grey leather and is powered by a 2.9-liter Ford Cologne V6 paired with a five-speed manual transmission. Equipment includes a black rear soft top, split removable top panels as well as 15" aluminium wheels, front disc brakes, leather-wrapped steering wheel, walnut-grain dashboard. Even though this car was imported from the US, it was initially moved there with the owner from the UK and is RHD. I can't give an opinion on how this drives as it has not been registered (even on club plates) so it has only been driven in the driveway, engine sounds decent and everything feels mechanically OK, but I honestly couldn't say.



All cars are currently residing in Llandilo, NSW. That said, the Capri will probably move to Robertson, NSW soon so that I can advertise it by driving around town. All prices are open to negotiation.

Call Mark (Bancroft) 0417 237 670 for more information.

Your Last Page



**Rob Roy Hillclimb
Victoria**

**Spot the
Austin-Healey**



**Provocative photo that somehow
does not look period.**



**Kirk Douglas was an Aus-
tin-Healey owner.**

No comment

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**